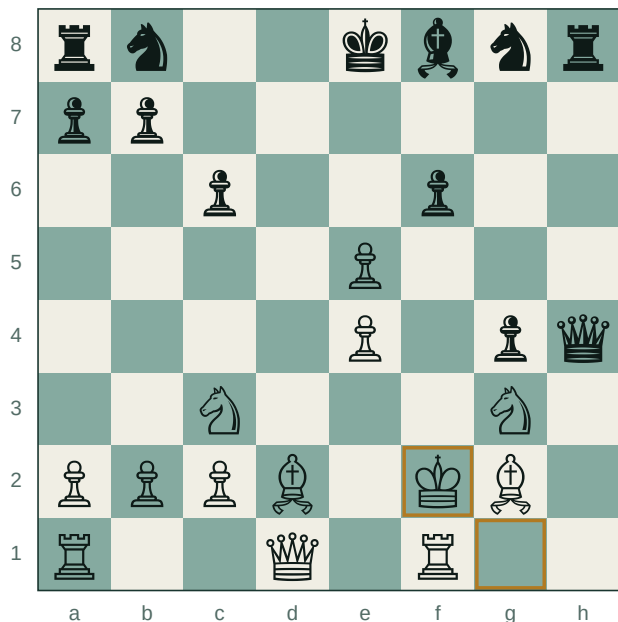


Attraction tactics: Black, move 17

Attraction tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 17.Kf2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

17...Bc5+ 18. Be3 Bxe3+ 19. Kxe3 Qxg3+

17...Bc5+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **18.Be3**.

18...Bxe3+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the bishop on e3. Recorded reply: **19.Kxe3**.

19...Qxg3+ Check restricts White to 6 legal replies here. From g3 it attacks king on e3 and bishop on g2.

At the end, nominal material is White 30 / Black 30 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -3 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on f2. Absolute pin: knight on g3.